

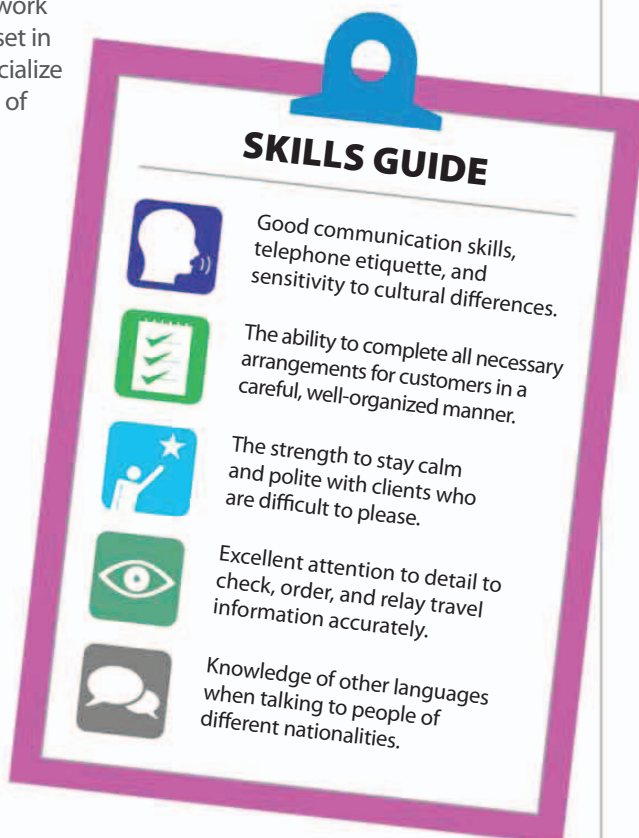
## CAREER PATHS

There is no set career path for a travel agent. Your network of contacts in the industry will be your most useful asset in seeking higher positions. You will stand out if you specialize in a few particular destinations or sell to specific kinds of travelers, such as those with special interests.

**ASSISTANT** You may start your career as an assistant with a travel agency. This role usually combines on-the-job training with work experience.



**TRAVEL AGENT** Once you have become a travel agent, industry-run courses in sales or customer care will help you develop your career. With experience, you can seek professional accreditation to move to more senior positions.



### TOUR OPERATOR

Plans and organizes group travel. The work includes organizing cruises, rail, and bus travel, or chartered flights to a selection of destinations.



### BUSINESS TRAVEL AGENT

Arranges travel and accommodation for corporate clients, negotiating special rates on their behalf.



### CALL CENTER AGENT

Sells travel products to customers on the telephone or the Internet, and handles product queries and complaints. May work shifts to deal with customer calls at evenings and weekends.



### RESORT REPRESENTATIVE

Represents a travel company at a vacation resort or destination, looking after the needs of vacationers and liaising with travel and accommodation suppliers.